RESOLUTION No. 7323

K–12 Comprehensive Health Education Curriculum Materials Adoption

RECITALS

A. High-quality, standards-aligned health education is essential to supporting the whole child—academically, socially, emotionally, and physically. Comprehensive health instruction equips students with the knowledge, skills, and confidence to make informed decisions, build healthy relationships, and contribute to safe and thriving communities. Research demonstrates that when health education is inclusive, skills-based, and scaffolded across grade levels, it produces improved school climate, reduced violence, increased academic achievement, and lasting intergenerational benefits.

B. The Health & Physical Education (HPE) Team has completed a rigorous, four-year Comprehensive K–12 Health Education Instructional Materials Adoption spanning five sub-content areas:

- Mental and Emotional Health
- Food, Nutrition, and Physical Activity
- Substance Use Prevention
- Comprehensive Sexuality Education
- Violence Prevention

C. The recommended instructional materials align with the 2025 Oregon Health Education Standards, meet the requirements of ODE Division 22, and reflect Portland Public Schools' district-wide priority to adopt High-Quality Instructional Materials across all core subject areas. The adoption also supports the District Continuous Improvement Plan (DCIP) priorities of increasing attendance, improving literacy, improving math, and supporting 9th-grade success.This adoption fulfills Portland Public Schools' obligations under multiple Oregon laws and mandates.

D. The adoption process followed Portland Public Schools' established Adoption of Instructional Resources (AIR) process, utilizing field-testing and committee review. Because no commercially available health textbooks adequately met Oregon's health education standards or provided the flexibility required to respond to student data (such as the Youth Risk Behavior Survey and the School Health Survey), the district partnered with specialized public health organizations including Advocates for Youth, Stanford's REACH Lab, and Cairn Guidance. Grant funding was secured to support the development of the Mental Health and Nutrition curricula, for which Cairn Guidance developed custom instructional materials.

E. Over the course of the adoption, Portland Public Schools engaged students, families, educators, and community partners in a meaningful and ongoing process. Engagement efforts included: an open house and evening listening session at the Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center; collaboration with the Village Table to review materials and gather community input; surveying over 207 students to inform culturally affirming and trauma-informed curriculum design; and

convening a youth panel to review and provide feedback on high school Comprehensive Sexuality Education lesson drafts.

F. On June 11, 2026, the Teaching, Learning, and Enrollment Committee reviewed and recommended forwarding the curriculum to the full Board for approval.

RESOLVED

1. The Board of Education accepts the Superintendent's recommendation to adopt and purchase the following K-12 Health curriculum adoption:

Sub-Content Area	**K–5**	**6–8**	**9–12**
Mental & Emotional Health	Cairn Guidance	Cairn Guidance; Signs of Suicide	Cairn Guidance; Signs of Suicide
Food, Nutrition & Physical Activity	Cairn Guidance	Cairn Guidance; Let's Eat!	Cairn Guidance
Substance Use Prevention	5th Grade: Stanford REACH Lab (K–4: RFP recommended)	Project ALERT; HealthSmart	Stanford REACH: Safety First
Comprehensive Sexuality Education	Advocates for Youth: Rights, Respect, Responsibility	ODHS: My Future–My Choice	Advocates for Youth: Rights, Respect, Responsibility
Violence Prevention	Second Step (Adopted 2023)	ODHS: My Future–My Choice	Nest Foundation: You Belong Here

2. The Board of Education thanks the members of the Comprehensive Health Education Adoption Instruction Resource Committee, pilot teachers and community members for their time and engagement in the selection of a K-12 Health curriculum.